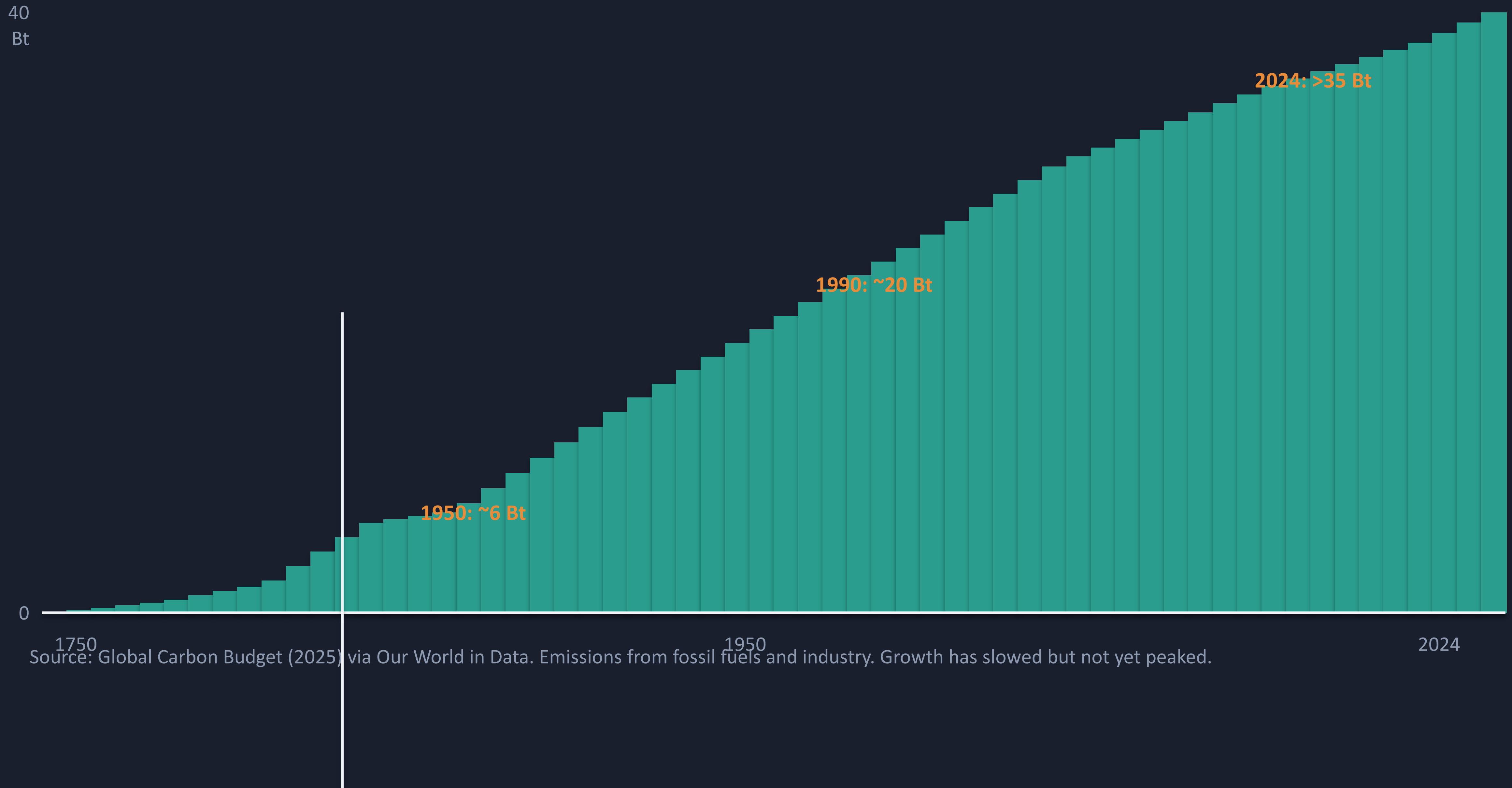
# Global $CO_2$ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry • 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data

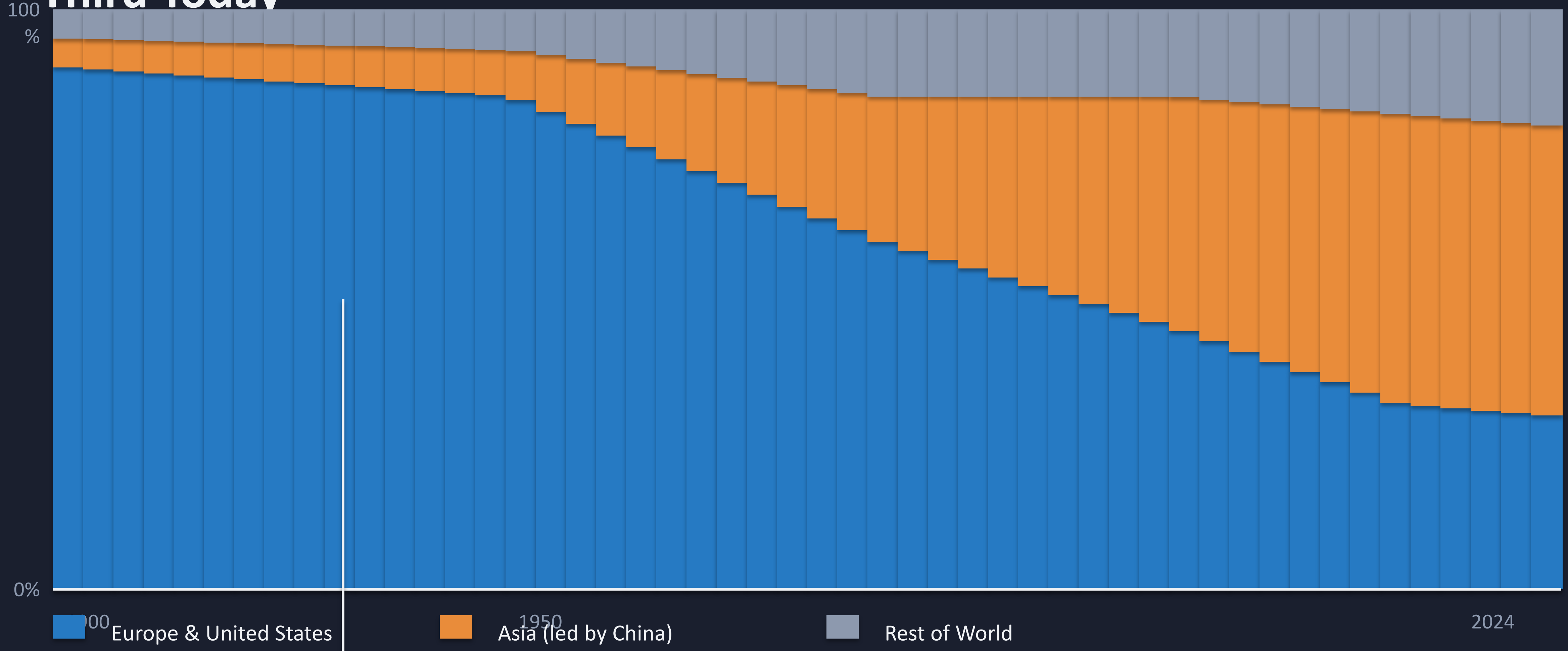
For policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers

# Global $CO_2$ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



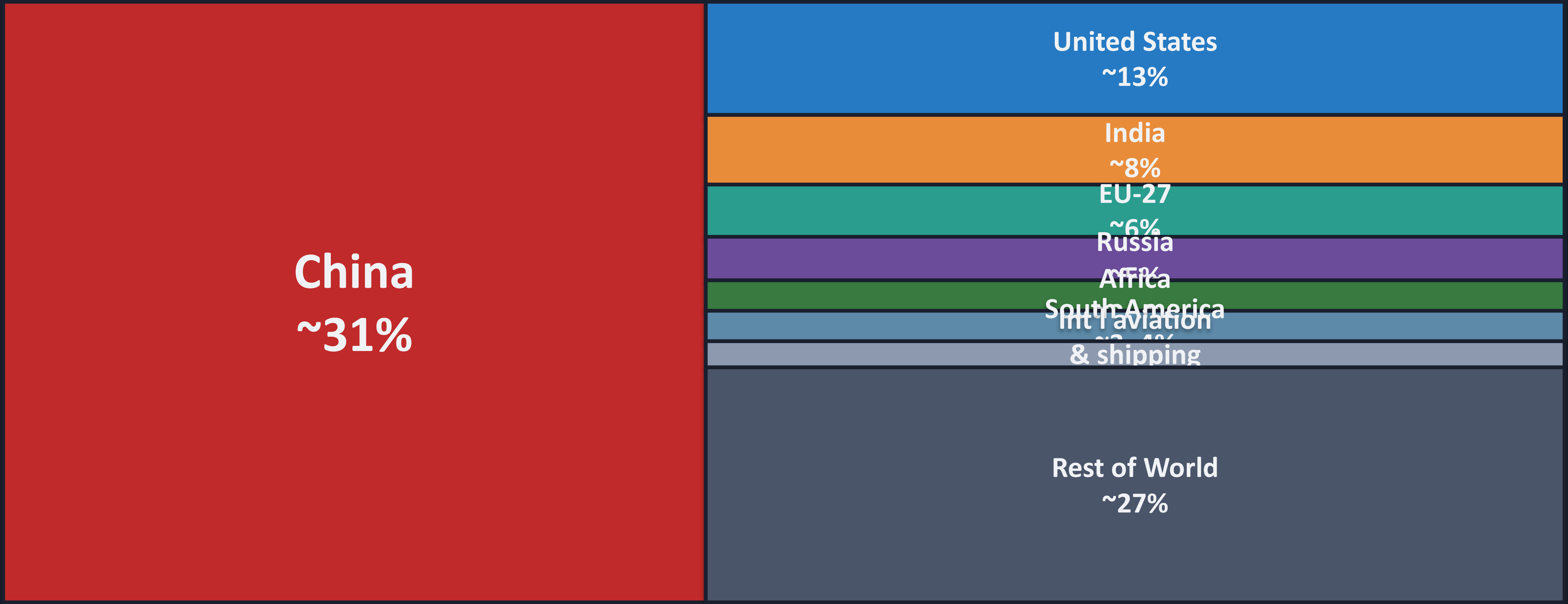

Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Emissions from fossil fuels and industry. Growth has slowed but not yet peaked.

# Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



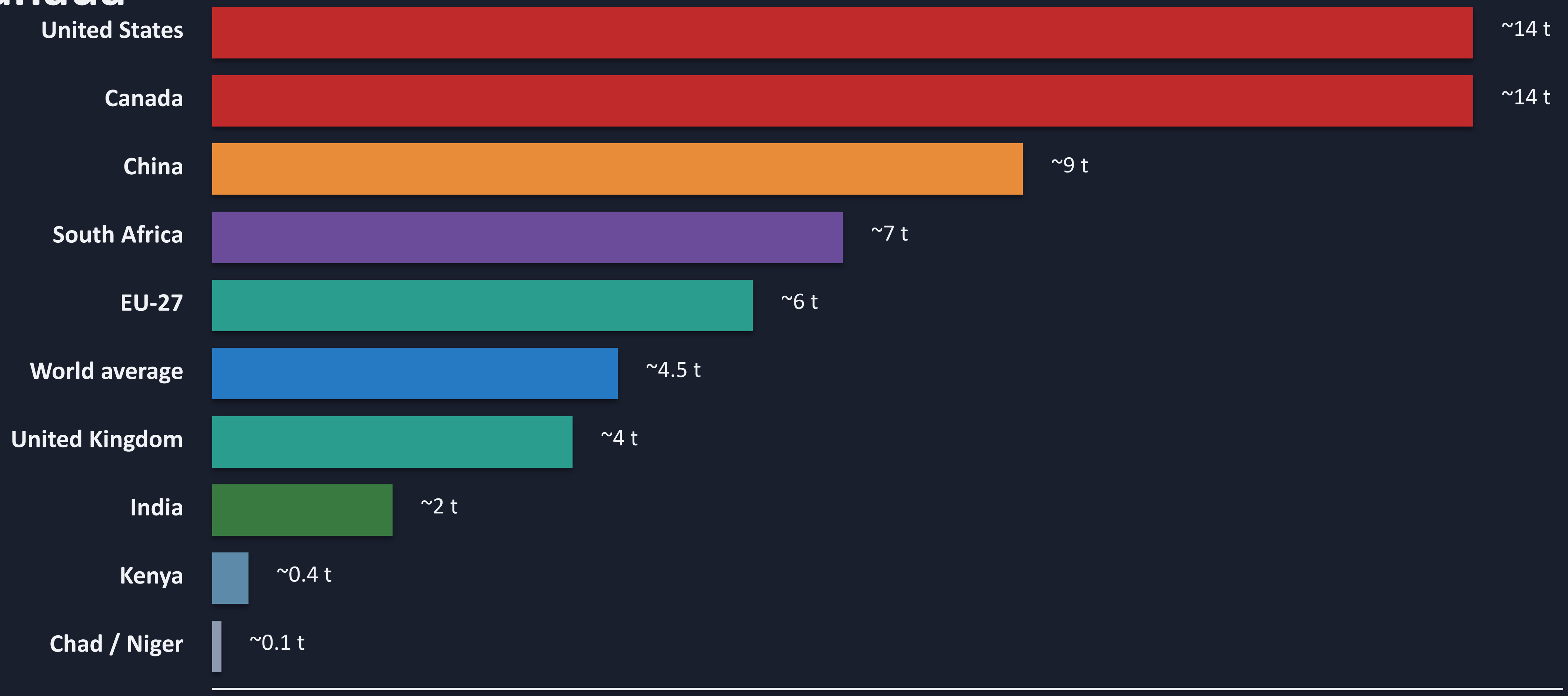

Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Share of global $CO_2$ from fossil fuels and industry.

# China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global $CO_2$




Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Approximate shares of global $CO_2$ from fossil fuels and industry, 2024.

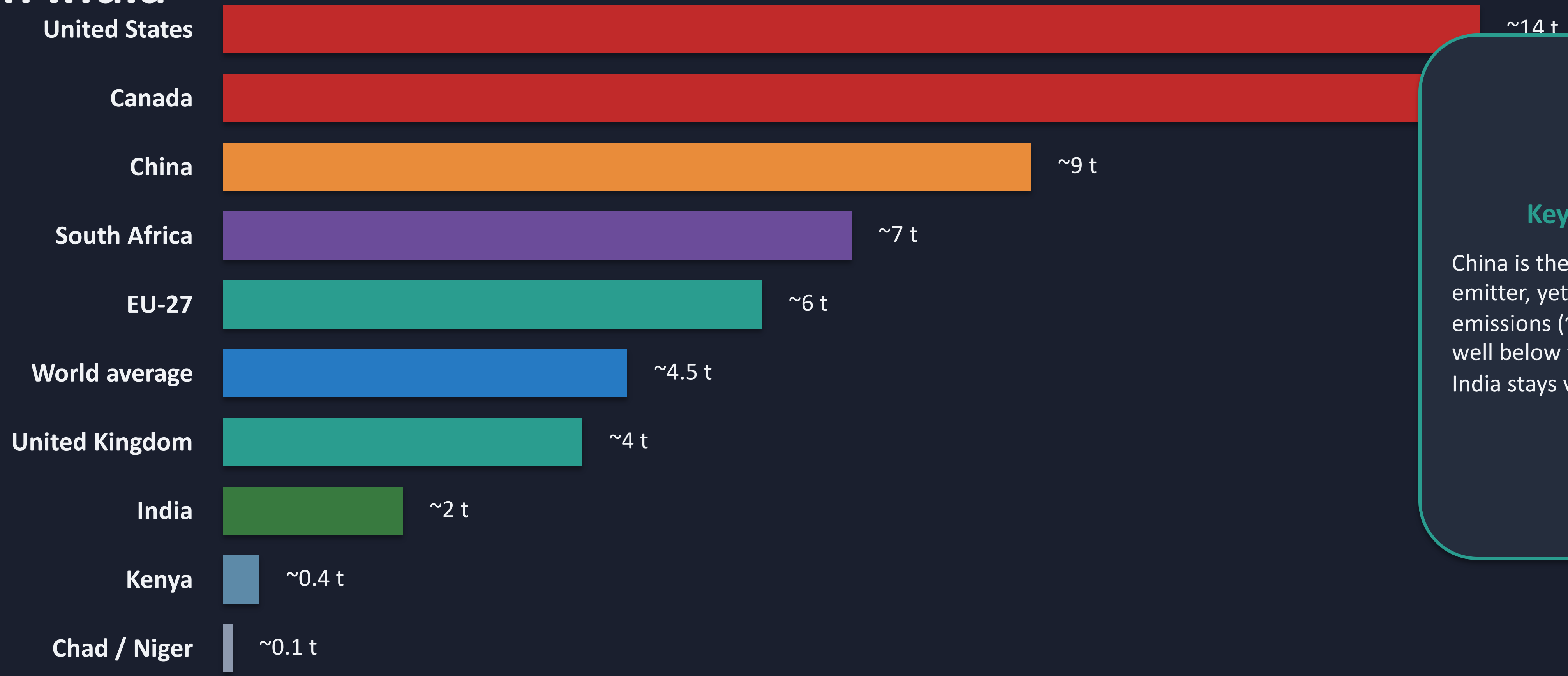
# Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada




**The gap is enormous: a roughly 150× difference between the highest large-country emitters and the lowest Sub-Saharan African nations.**

Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Per capita $CO_2$ from fossil fuels and industry, 2024.

# Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

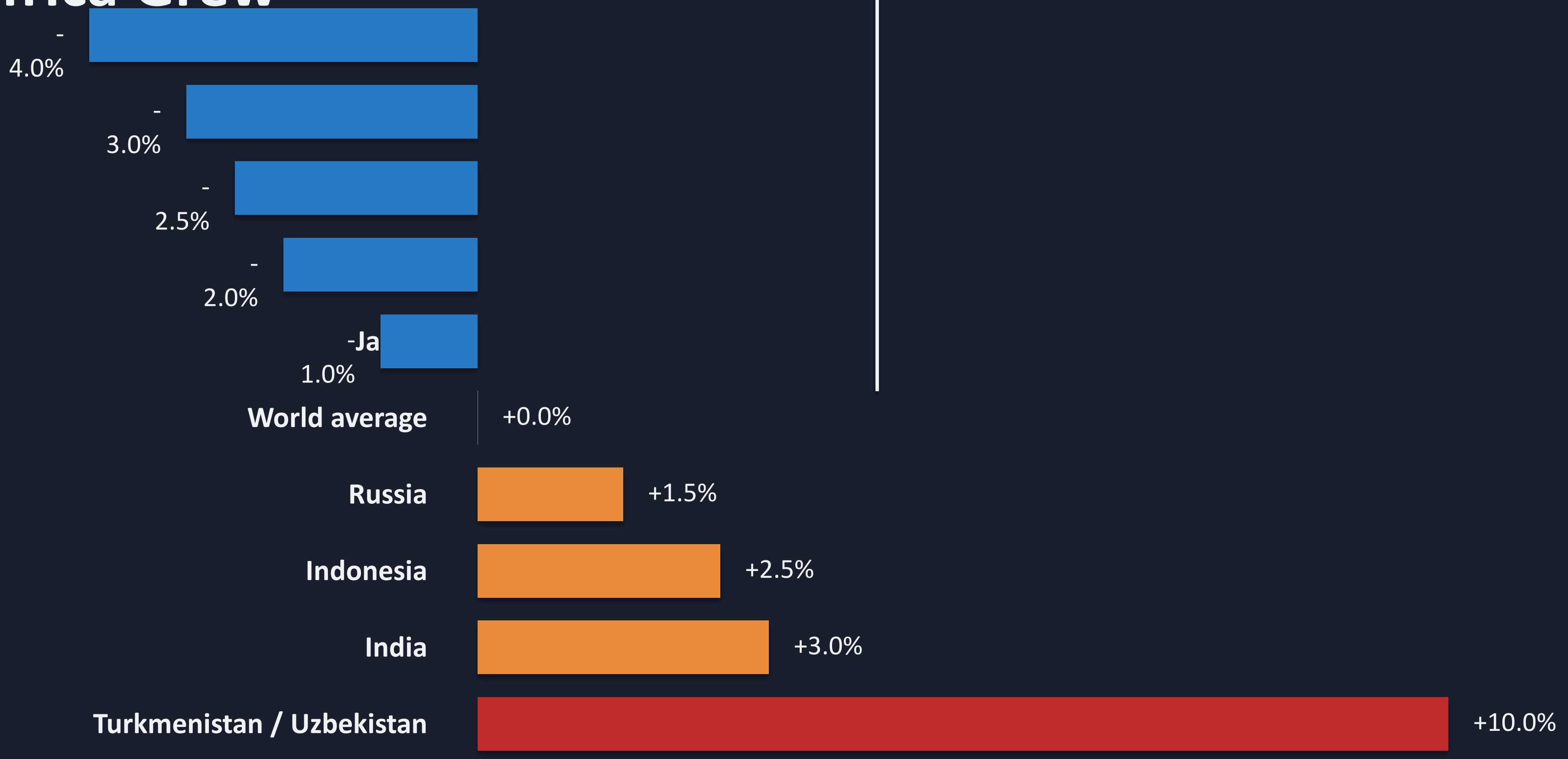



### Key insight

China is the largest total emitter, yet its per capita emissions (~9 t) remain well below the US (~14 t). India stays very low at ~2 t.

Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Per capita $CO_2$ from fossil fuels and industry, 2024.

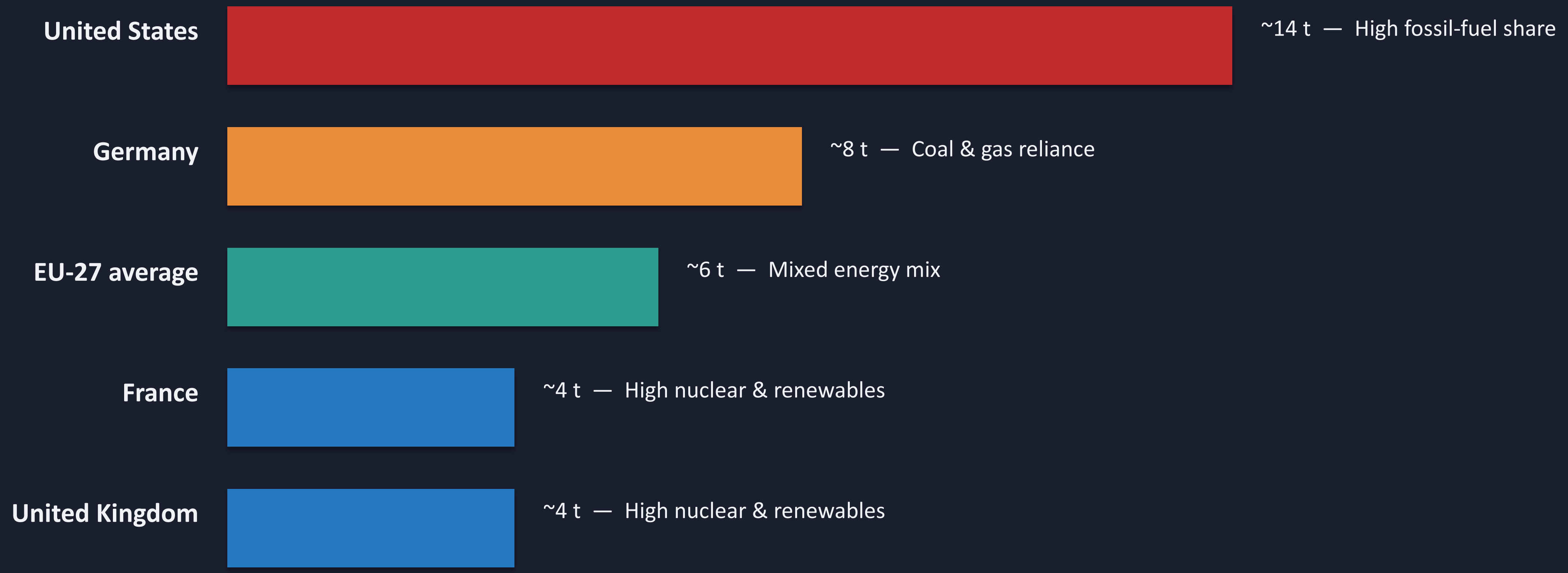
# 2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew




▼ Decline ▲ Increase

Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Annual percentage change in $CO_2$ emissions from fossil fuels and industry, 2024.

# Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US




Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity levels, per capita emissions vary significantly because of energy mix choices. France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US, largely because a higher share of their electricity comes from nuclear and renewable sources rather than fossil fuels.

Source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data. Approximate per capita $CO_2$ from fossil fuels and industry, 2024.

# Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

1. No peak yet — Global $CO_2$ emissions from fossil fuels exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not yet peaked, despite slowing growth.

2. China is the largest annual emitter, but per capita emissions (~9 t) remain well below the US (~14 t).

3. Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US — they accounted for >90% of emissions in 1900.

4. Per capita gaps of 150× persist between the richest large-country emitters and the poorest Sub-Saharan African nations.

5. Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions — France and the UK prove it.

Data: Global Carbon Budget (2025) via Our World in Data • ourworldindata.org/co2-emissions